THE FINE PRINT · LONG-TERM CARE INSURANCE

Questions to Ask the Insurer Before You File

Have the policy in hand when you call. The example answers in teal show how one family filled it in. Every policy is different, so get answers in writing.

1. The policy

Find it before you call.

- ☐ Insurer, policy number and claims phone
  Example: Policy number on page 1
- ☐ Does it cover care at home, or only in a facility?
  Example: Home, adult day and facility
- ☐ Daily benefit limit and lifetime maximum
  Example: Both listed on the schedule page

2. What starts benefits

Called the benefit trigger.

- ☐ Help needed with how many daily activities?
  Example: Two of six, like bathing and dressing
- ☐ Does a cognitive impairment qualify on its own?
  Example: Yes, with the insurer's assessment
- ☐ Does the doctor need to send anything?
  Example: Records from Dr. Lee, sent Nov. 4

3. The waiting period

Also called the elimination period.

- ☐ How many days?
  Example: 90 days
- ☐ Calendar days or service days?
  Example: Service days, so only days with covered care count
- ☐ Who pays during the wait?
  Example: We do, and we keep every invoice

4. Assessment and plan of care

Get names and direct numbers.

- ☐ Who does the assessment, and when?
  Example: Insurer's nurse, home visit Nov. 12
- ☐ Who approves the plan of care?
  Example: Care manager Dana M., ext. 2210
- ☐ Does the home care agency need to send its own care plan?
  Example: Yes, with the first invoice

5. What it pays for at home

Ask about each kind of help.

- ☐ Personal care like bathing and dressing?
  Example: Yes
- ☐ Homemaking and meals?
  Example: Only on days with personal care
- ☐ Must the caregiver come from a licensed agency?
  Example: Yes
- ☐ Does the insurer pay us, or the agency directly?
  Example: Agency can bill the insurer

6. Filing the claim

Write down every call.

- ☐ Claim forms: how to get them and where to send
  Example: Requested by phone Nov. 3
- ☐ Proof needed for each day of care
  Example: Daily care log and invoices
- ☐ Date, name and reference number for every call
  Example: Nov. 3, Sam, ref. 77412
- ☐ Questions? Illinois Dept. of Insurance: (312) 814-2420
  Example: Not needed

Questions about care at home? Call us. Care can often start within 24 to 48 hours of signing on.

Right at Home Hinsdale: (630) 366-0300 · homecarehinsdale.com

Let's start talking about living.

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